LEADING FROM A DISTANCE

REMOTE INFLUENCING

PARTICIPANT WORKBOOK

onpoint CONSULTING | Closing the Gap Between Strategy and Execution

OBJECTIVES

- Understand how effective managers gain the support of people over whom they have no direct authority
- Recognize the four influence behaviors that are most effective when leading and collaborating from a distance
- Learn when each influence behavior would be most and least effective

AGENDA

- OnPoint's Virtual Team Research
- Influence in a Virtual Setting
- Outcomes of Influence Attempts
- Most Effective Tactics for Gaining Commitment
- Influence Case Scenarios
- Tips for Influencing in a Virtual Environment

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ONPOINT'S GLOBAL VIRTUAL TEAM STUDY KEY FINDINGS

The results of OnPoint's study indicate that more than 25% of virtual teams were not fully performing. Another study conducted by MIT has found that up to 82% of virtual teams are not effective. Many organizations simply recycle practices for co-located teams without really considering what makes virtual collaboration unique.

So, what factors determine the success of a virtual team? Our research shows that the following characteristics differentiated top performing virtual teams from the rest:

- Team Composition
    - Stable Team Membership
    - Smaller in size
    - Functional teams
    - Team members on fewer teams
    - Longer tenure as a team
- Communication and Training
    - Face-to-face meetings
    - Effective "v-meetings"
    - Well-leveraged technology
    - Skill development
- Effective Leadership

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The most effective virtual teams use strategies to balance the execution-oriented skills and behaviors with the interpersonal and communication skills that are critical for virtual team success.

The **RAMP** Model is based on OnPoint Consulting's comprehensive global research that focused on what the most effective virtual teams and team leaders do when working and leading from a distance. It is designed to serve as a roadmap that provides practical steps to accelerate performance for virtual teams. The model is composed of four components that are critical to success:

Relationships – Interpersonal Communication, Trust, and Conflict Resolution

Accountability – Holding Team Members/Remote Employees Accountable, Taking Personal Accountability, and Achieving Team Results/Commitments

Motivation – Inspirational Leadership, Influence Skills, and Coaching

Purpose and **P**rocess – Creating a Sense of Purpose, and Establishing and Using Effective Virtual Team Processes

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INFLUENCING AND GAINING COMMITMENT REMOTELY

What is Influence?

Getting people to change their behavior, opinion, attitude or accept your point of view in a way that meets their needs and without coercion or a feeling of being directed.

To be effective as a manager, it is necessary to influence people to carry out requests, support proposals, and implement decisions. In large organizations, the effectiveness of individuals depends on their influence over bosses and peers as well as their influence over direct and/or indirect reports. Influence in one direction tends to enhance influence in other directions. The success of an influence attempt is clearly a matter of degree. The person making the influence attempt may modify the "target" person's attitudes and behavior in the desired direction without necessarily achieving all that was intended.

You may need to adapt your influencing approach when working remotely:

- Lack of face-to-face interaction makes it more difficult to build relationships and trust
- Fewer opportunities to establish credibility
- Less frequent contact makes it more difficult to get an understanding of the needs and goals of others
- Lack of visual cues increases the possibility of misunderstandings

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INFLUENCE OUTCOMES

It is useful to differentiate among three distinct outcomes of influence attempts.

Commitment

The term commitment describes an outcome in which another person agrees with your decision or request and makes a great effort to carry out the request or implement the decision effectively. Commitment brings with it self-discipline that does not need monitoring. People who are fully committed engage in discretionary effort. For a complex, difficult task, commitment is usually the most successful outcome from the perspective of the person who makes an influence attempt.

Compliance

Compliance is an outcome in which another person is willing to do what you ask but is apathetic rather than enthusiastic about it and will only do the minimum required. You have influenced the person's behavior but not their attitudes. The person is not convinced that the decision or action is the best thing to do or even that it will be effective. For a complex, difficult task, compliance is a less successful outcome than commitment. However, for a simple, routine request, compliance may be all that is necessary to accomplish the task objectives.

Resistance

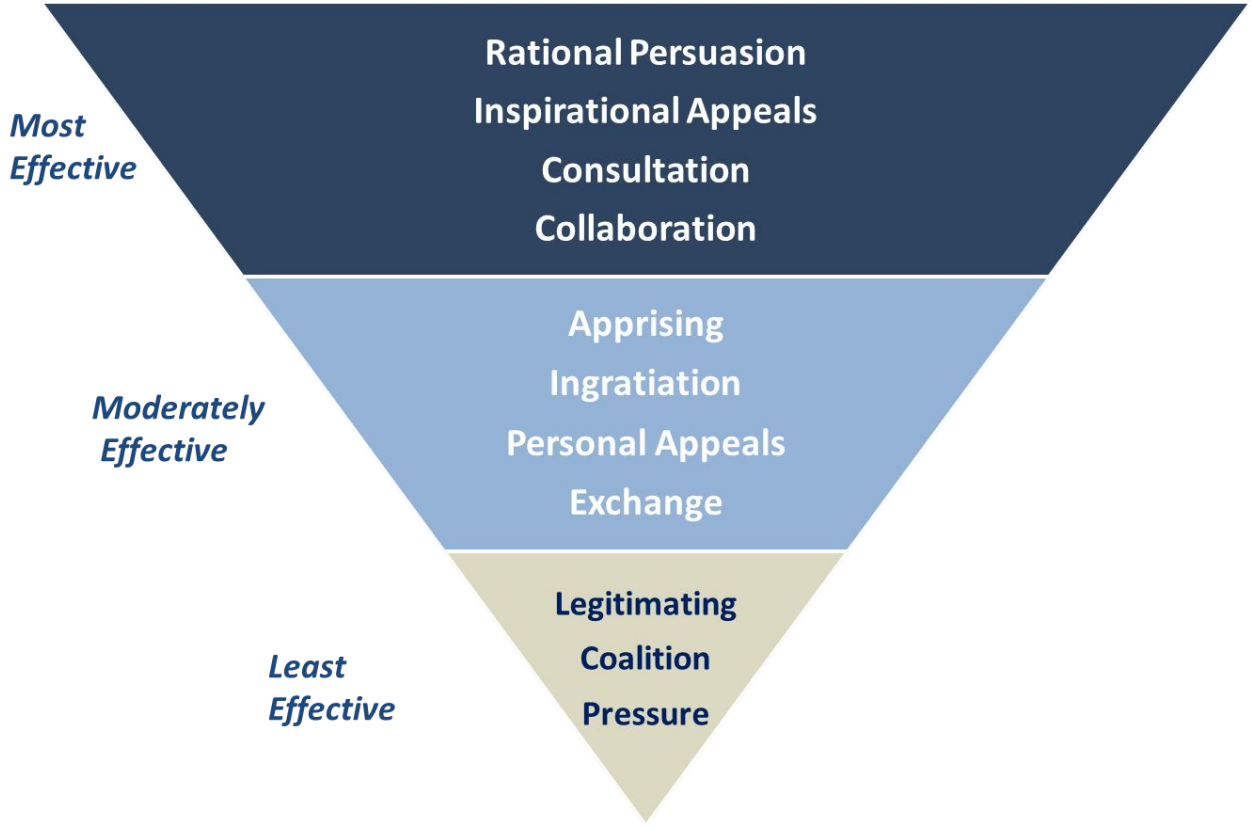
Resistance is an outcome in which the other person is opposed to the proposal or request, rather than merely indifferent about it, and actively tries to avoid carrying it out. The person will respond in one or more of the following ways: (1) make excuses about why the request cannot be carried out; (2) try to persuade you to withdraw or change the request; (3) ask higher authorities to overrule your request; (4) delay acting in the hope that you will forget about the request; (5) make a pretense of complying but try to sabotage the task; or (6) refuse to carry out the request.

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PROACTIVE INFLUENCE TACTICS

The most common form of influence behavior is a "simple request." Compliance by the person you are trying to influence is likely for a simple request that is clearly legitimate, relevant for the work, and something the person knows how to do. Commitment is an unlikely outcome for a simple request, except under the most favorable of conditions. However, if the requested action would be unpleasant, inconvenient, irrelevant, or difficult to do, the person's reaction is likely to be resistance.

For many types of influence attempts it is necessary to use another form of influence behavior called a "proactive influence tactic." There are 11 proactive influence tactics that are relevant for influencing direct reports, peers, and bosses:



1.

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Rational Persuasion: Using logical arguments and factual evidence to show that a request or proposal is feasible and relevant for important task objectives.

2. **Inspirational Appeals:** Appealing to a person's values and ideals or seeking to arouse the person's emotions to gain commitment for a request or proposal.

3. **Consultation:** Asking the person to suggest improvements or help plan a proposed activity or change for which the person's support is desired.

4. **Collaboration:** Offering to provide relevant resources or assistance if the person will carry out a request or approve a proposed change.

5. **Apprising:** Explaining how carrying out a request or supporting a proposal will benefit the person personally or will help to advance the person's career.

6. **Ingratiation:** Using praise and flattery before or during an attempt to influence someone to carry out a request or support a proposal.

7. **Personal Appeals:** Asking the person to carry out a request or support a proposal out of friendship, or asks for a personal favor before saying what it is.

8. **Exchange:** Offering something the person wants, or offering to reciprocate at a later time, if the person will do what you request.

9. **Legitimating Tactics:** Establishing the legitimacy of a request or verifying that you have the authority to make it.

10. **Coalition Tactics:** Enlisting the aid of others, or using the support of others, as a way to influence someone to do something.

11. **Pressure:** Using demands, threats, frequent checking, or persistent reminders to influence someone to do something.

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THE MOST EFFECTIVE INFLUENCE TACTICS

Rational Persuasion

Rational persuasion is a flexible tactic that can be used for most types of influence attempts. It is most appropriate when the target person shares the same task objectives as the agent but does not recognize the proposal is the best way to attain the objectives.

- **Explain the reason for a request or proposal:** Explain how a proposal would help to achieve an important objective you share in common with the person, such as improved quality, service, or productivity.
- **Provide evidence that your proposal is feasible:** It is not enough for a request or proposal to be relevant; it must also be seen as practical and realistic to gain the person's enthusiastic support and cooperation.
- **Explain why your proposal is better than competing ones**
- **Explain how likely problems or concerns would be handled:** Make it clear how you propose to avoid potential problems, overcome likely obstacles, and minimize risks.

Inspirational Appeals

An inspirational appeal is an attempt to develop enthusiasm and commitment by arousing strong emotions and linking a request or proposal to a person's needs, values, and ideals.

- **Appeal to the person's ideals and values:** Most people aspire to be important, to feel useful, to accomplish something worthwhile, to make an important contribution, to be a member of the best team, or to participate in an exciting effort to make things better.
- **Link the request to the person's self-image:** A proposed activity or assignment may be linked to values that are central to the person's self-image as a professional or a member of an organization.
- **Link the request to a clear and appealing vision**
- **Use a dramatic, expressive style of speaking:** Use a strong, clear tone of voice, but vary the pace and intensity. Use pauses at appropriate times to maintain interest, and arouse excitement. Maintain strong eye contact, use strong gestures, and move around to display energy.
- **Use positive, optimistic language:** Use positive language that communicates you are confident a proposed project or change will be successful.

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Consultation

The target person is invited to participate in planning how to carry out a request or implement a proposed change.

- **State your objective and ask what the person can do to help:** When you do not expect the target person to be enthusiastic about helping you accomplish an objective, it is helpful to explain why it is important (rational persuasion), then ask the person what he or she can do to help you attain it.
- **Ask for suggestions on how to improve a tentative proposal:** More participation is likely if you present a proposal as tentative and encourage people to improve it, rather than asking people to react to an elaborate plan that appears complete.
- **Involve the person in planning how to attain an objective:** Present a general strategy or objective and ask the target person to suggest specific action steps for implementing it.
- **Respond to the person's concerns and suggestions:** Whenever feasible, try to deal with the target person's concerns, even if it requires modification of your initial plans.

Collaboration

This influence tactic involves an offer to provide necessary resources and/or assistance if the target person will carry out a request or approve a proposal. Collaboration involves reducing the difficulty or costs of carrying out a request, and it is especially appropriate when compliance would be difficult for the target person.

- **Offer to provide necessary assistance or resources:** If the person lacks experience in doing the task, offer to provide advice and guidance. If the task is unpleasant, offer to help the person do it.
- **Offer to help the person solve problems caused by a request:** A request is more likely to be resisted if it will cause new problems that will increase the cost of compliance beyond an acceptable level. Try to anticipate such problems and be prepared to offer ways to avoid them or help the person deal with them.
- **Offer to help the person implement a proposed change:** A major source of resistance to change is the extra work that would be involved in implementing it in the target person's unit or job. To gain the person's support and approval for a proposed change, offer to help the person implement it. A requirement for the use of this tactic is the capability to actually provide assistance in implementing the proposed change, which is most likely when the target person is a direct report.

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EXERCISE

Marcia, a product manager, works with many people around the world who design, develop, and market her product. She is a member of a virtual team and has to get work done with people who do not report to her.

In each of the following scenarios, identify the tactic Marcia is using to influence her peers and colleagues.

#1: Marketing Snafu

Marcia is getting frustrated with James, the person responsible for developing the basic campaign for the new release. Marcia is nervous about delivering on time.

She decides to discuss this directly with James. It turns out that James has a wealth of information about process, costs, and efficiencies which Marcia didn't know about. Marcia asked James if he would work with her to establish project goals in order to communicate realistic expectations to management.

Tactic used_____

#2: Feature Swap

The development team has been pushing a certain feature to be included in the next release of the software. Marcia doesn't seem to believe that it will enhance the product for her targeted customers of younger users. The development team doesn't agree but Marcia and the members of this virtual team have worked together before so there is a high level of trust.

Marcia decides that the best approach is to remind the developers of the core values of the company and the product team: customer value and user experience.

Tactic used_____

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#3: Pricing Strategy

Marcia is working with her colleagues in pricing to figure out what the best price point should be for her product in order to make it attractive to the customer and maximize the return on the investment made by her group. They are all aligned with her objectives – they just aren't sure about her numbers. She presents some data to support her recommendation.

Tactic used_____

#4: Reseller Reluctance

Marcia is working with the reseller to try and highlight her new release with a seminar attended by their best customers who will likely be interested in the new product. However, the reseller is being resistant and making excuses which don't seem credible to her. Finally, she decides to talk to the reseller manager to find out what the problem is.

Marcia finds out that the reseller's owner is trying to comply with Marcia's company's contractual requirements that were just announced. Marcia decides to help the reseller by bringing a team of company representatives from all of the appropriate departments to help the reseller understand the terms and help with compliance without causing additional work. The reseller agrees and schedules the client seminar.

Tactic used_____

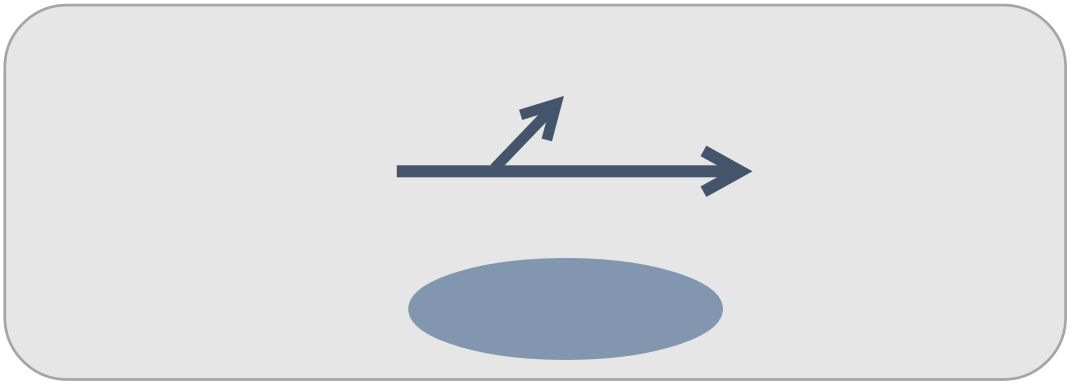
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FACTORS THAT SUPPORT AND HINDER THE USE OF INFLUENCE TACTICS

Most Effective Tactics		
Influence Tactic	**Supporting Factors**	**Limiting Factors**
Simple Request	▪ Your request is clearly legitimate, relevant for the work, and something the person knows how to do	▪ Your request is unpleasant, inconvenient, irrelevant, or difficult to do
Rational Persuasion	▪ You and the person share task objectives ▪ You are seen as an expert ▪ You have a track record of success ▪ Can be used effectively with boss, peers and direct reports	▪ Goals or task objectives are not aligned ▪ You have a poor track record in areas related to the request or proposal ▪ You are not seen a credible expert in areas relevant to the request or proposal
Inspirational Appeals	▪ Most effective with direct reports and peers ▪ Objective is to gain commitment to work on a new project or support for a proposed change ▪ You know the person's values and what motivates them	▪ The person is the boss ▪ You have a poor personal relationship with the person ▪ The person lacks trust and/or respect for you ▪ You do not know the person very well or what motivates them
Consultation	▪ Most effective with direct reports and peers ▪ You have the authority to assign work or make changes ▪ The person's cooperation is needed for effective implementation ▪ The person has relevant information that you do not ▪ The person agrees in principle with the objective	▪ You have a poor relationship with the person ▪ The person is not willing to be open and provide suggestions or raise concerns ▪ The person does not have the expertise to make a meaningful contribution ▪ The person's cooperation is not necessary for successful implementation ▪ The person does not agree with the task objective
Collaboration	▪ Most effective with peers ▪ You can provide additional resources to help the person ▪ You can reduce the difficulty or cost of carrying out a request	▪ The person is the boss ▪ You do not have any way to reduce difficulty or unpleasantness of carrying out the request ▪ You cannot reduce the cost of compliance without creating a new problem

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RESISTANCE STRATEGIES



Provide: Answer the question, "What's in it for me?" (the WIFM)

Surface: Make it safe to express; respect what you hear; don't try to sell or counter argue. It's okay to clarify, but avoid defending your position.

Acknowledge: This doesn't imply that you agree or disagree. Listen to the resistance; you're getting information about the pitfalls of the change.

Explore: Ask for concrete information and avoid "why" questions; they typically elicit a defensive response. Ask "what" and "how."

Engage: *What do we want to create together?* Interdependence helps create a "we" instead of an "I" need or "I" want.

INFLUENCE TACTICS SELF-ASSESSMENT

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Part I. When trying to influence another person to do a requested action or task, which response below best describes your behavior? Do not be concerned at this point whether the other person is a subordinate/direct report, peer or boss/superior.

Directions: Using the scales below, please rate each question.

0 = Never or rarely do	**1** = Sometimes, with some people	**2** = Most times, with most people

ITEM	RATING
1. Confront the other person and demand that the requested action be done promptly.	
2. Show the other person how the requested action meets both organizational goals but also fits with the other person's values and goals.	
3. Mention to the other person that a higher authority within the organization also wants the requested action to be done.	
4. Offer data or factual evidence as a reason for why the requested action needs to be done by the other person.	
5. Offer to do a favor or task that would benefit the other person in exchange for the other person doing the requested action.	
6. Express sincere respect and praise to the other person when requesting him/her to do the action or task.	
7. Allow the other person to participate in the decision-making on the requested action or task.	
8. Get several other people to support the requested action before asking the other person to do the requested action.	
9. Ask the other person to do the requested action based on your personal loyalty or friendship.	
10. Offer to provide any assistance a person would need to carry out a request.	
11. Describe benefits a person could gain from doing a task or activity (e.g., learn new skills, meet important people, enhance his/her reputation).	
12. Repeatedly remind the other person about deadlines, goals, expectations and consequences until the requested action or task is accomplished.	
13. Describe the task with enthusiasm and express confidence in the other person's ability to accomplish the requested task.	
14. Mention to the other person that the requested action should be done based on the company's strategic plan or mission, its policies and rules, or based on your position or authority within the company.	
15. Objectively and logically explain to the other person the reason for the requested action.	

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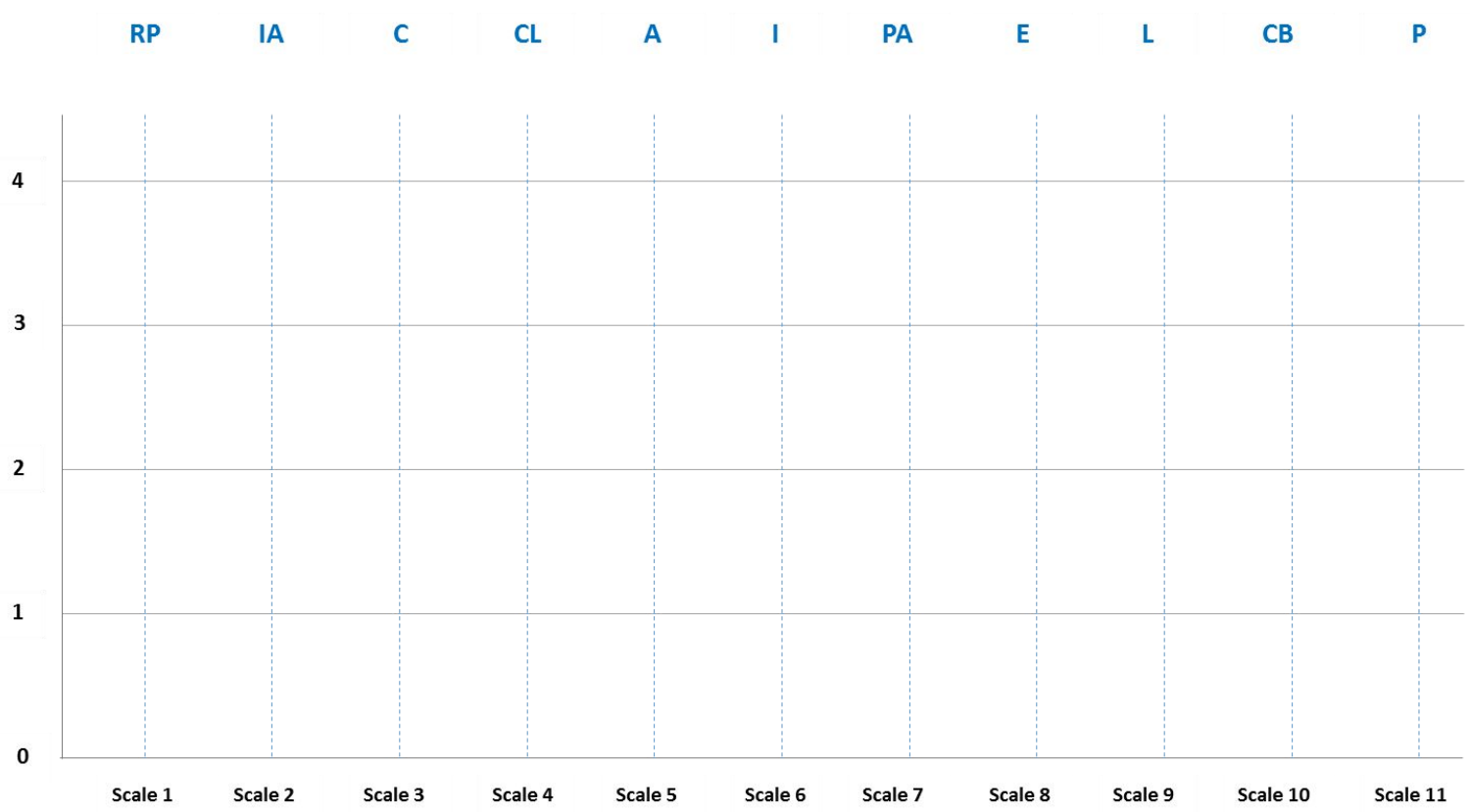
16. Offer an extra incentive or reward to the other person for doing the requested action.	
17. Compliment the other person before asking him/her to do the action or task.	
18. Ask the other person for his/her ideas and input into how he/she should do the requested action or task.	
19. Have several people, who are in support of the requested action, also ask the other person to do the requested action.	
20. Ask the other person to do the requested action as a personal favor to you.	
21. Offer to provide resources a person would need to do a proposed task or carry out a request.	
22. Explain how a proposed activity or change could help a person attain a personal objective.	

Part II. Add up your points for each of the items in the following manner:

Scale 1	Questions 4 + 15 =	Your **RP** (Rational Persuasion) score
Scale 2	Questions 2 + 13 =	Your **IA** (Inspirational Appeals) score
Scale 3	Questions 7 + 18 =	Your **C** (Consultation) score
Scale 4	Questions 10 + 21 =	Your **CL** (Collaboration) score
Scale 5	Questions 11 + 22 =	Your **A** (Apprising) score
Scale 6	Questions 6 + 17 =	Your **I** (Ingratiation) score
Scale 7	Questions 9 + 20 =	Your **PA** (Personal Appeals) score
Scale 8	Questions 5 + 16 =	Your **E** (Exchange) score
Scale 9	Questions 3 + 14 =	Your **L** (Legitimating) score
Scale 10	Questions 8 + 19 =	Your **CB** (Coalition Building) score
Scale 11	Questions 1 + 12 =	Your **P** (Pressure) score

Part III. Plot each of your scores on the graph:

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WAYS OF INFLUENCING

Most Effective Influence Tactics

Rational Persuasion: The person influencing uses logical arguments and factual evidence to persuade the person that a proposal or request is viable and likely to result in the attainment of task objectives.

Inspirational Appeals: The person influencing makes a request or proposal that arouses the person's enthusiasm by appealing to his or her values, ideals and aspirations, or by increasing the person's self-confidence.

Consultation: The person influencing seeks the person's participation in planning a strategy, activity or change for which the person's support and assistance are desired, or is willing to modify a proposal to deal with that person's concerns and suggestions.

Collaboration: The person influencing offers to provide relevant resources or assistance if the person will carry out a request or approve a proposed change.

Moderately Effective Tactics

Apprising: The person influencing explains how a request or proposal is likely to benefit the other person as an individual. The benefits may involve the person's career advancement, job satisfaction, or compensation.

Ingratiation: The person influencing uses praise, flattery, friendly behavior or helpful behavior to get the person in a good mood or to think favorably of him or her before asking for something.

Personal Appeal: The person influencing appeals to the person's feelings of loyalty and friendship toward him or her when asking for something.

Exchange: The person influencing offers an exchange of favors, indicates willingness to reciprocate at a later time or promises a share of the benefits if the person helps accomplish a task.

Least Effective Tactics

Legitimating: The person influencing seeks to establish the legitimacy of a request by claiming the authority or right to make it, or by verifying that it is consistent with organizational policies, rules, practices or traditions.

Coalition Building: The person influencing seeks the aid of others to persuade the person to do something, or uses the support of others as a reason for the person to also agree.

Pressure: The person influencing uses demands, frequent checking or persistent reminders to influence the person to do what he or she wants.

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Tactic	How To Use
Rational Persuasion	▪ Explain the reason for a request or proposal. ▪ Explain how the person would benefit from your proposal. ▪ Provide evidence that your proposal is feasible. ▪ Explain why your proposal is better than competing ones. ▪ Explain how likely problems or concerns would be handled.
Inspirational Appeals	▪ Appeal to the person's ideals and values. ▪ Link the request to the person's self-image. ▪ Link the request to a clear and appealing vision. ▪ Use a dramatic, expressive style of speaking. ▪ Use positive, optimistic language.
Consultation	▪ Ask for suggestions on how to improve a tentative proposal. ▪ State your objective and ask what the person can do to help you attain it. ▪ Involve the person in planning how to attain an objective. ▪ Respond to the person's concerns and suggestions.
Collaboration	▪ Offer to provide necessary assistance or resources. ▪ Offer to help the person solve problems caused by a request. ▪ Offer to help the person implement a proposed change.
Apprising	▪ Explain how a task would help the person's career. ▪ Explain the personal benefits from a proposed change. ▪ Explain the likely benefits for the person's organization.
Ingratiation	▪ Compliment the person on past achievements. ▪ Emphasize the person's unique qualifications. ▪ Be sympathetic about problems caused by your request. Be sensitive to the person's moods.
Personal Appeal	▪ Appeal to friendship for a personal favor. ▪ Explain why the request is important to you. ▪ Say that you are counting on the person's help. ▪ Say you need to ask for a favor before saying what it is.
Exchange	▪ Offer to share the benefits. ▪ Offer an incentive unrelated to the task. ▪ Offer to help the person carry out the request. ▪ Offer to do some of the person's regular work.

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	▪ Modify your request to make it easier to do. ▪ Indicate that you will "owe" the person a favor.
Legitimating	▪ Refer to organization policies and rules. ▪ Verify legitimacy by referring to a written document. ▪ Say your request is "approved" by someone with authority. ▪ Invoke tradition or precedent.
Coalition Building	▪ Mention credible people who support your proposal. ▪ Bring someone along to help you in an influence attempt. ▪ Get other people to provide evidence or an endorsement. ▪ Ask someone with higher authority to help you.
Pressure	▪ Use persistent requests. ▪ Remind the person he or she agreed to do something for you. ▪ Check frequently on the person's progress. ▪ Ask the person for a specific date when the task will be done.

TIPS FOR INFLUENCING IN A VIRTUAL ENVIRONMENT

<u>DO:</u>

- Lay the foundation for the effective use of the tactics well in advance
  - Demonstrate your credibility and track record
  - Identify shared goals or common ground
  - Build positive work relationships and trust
  - Get to know the needs and values of the people you depend on to get things done
  - Clarify what resources you control that others need or would like
- Do not over rely on rational persuasion
- Influence people from their point of view, not your own
- Translate “facts” and “features” into benefits
- Increase your use of paraphrasing, empathizing and questions

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AVOID:

- Assuming the same response time as in FTF interactions
- Making hasty conclusions about the other person's or group's reaction to your proposal
- Focusing too heavily on tasks and losing sight of relationships
- Overusing email
- Using pressure tactics before you've tried all other options (and only if the stakes are high)

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INFLUENCING PLAN WORKSHEET

Person or group to be influenced: _____

- Purpose of influence attempt (specific change in attitude, perception, and or behavior):

- What are this person's or group's objectives, values, and needs?

- To what extent are there shared goals and/or areas of common ground?

- How would you assess the quality of your relationship with this person or group? The level of trust?

- Do you need commitment or compliance in this situation?

- What are some possible objections to your proposal this person or group might have?

- What tactic is likely to be the most effective? Why? What are the limitations of using it?

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LEARNING JOURNAL

1. Based on today's session, what do you see as your key strengths as a leader?

2. What would you like to improve?

3. What specific insights or learnings from today will you apply back on the job?

4. List below the next steps you'll take to apply your learnings. Identify specific actions that you will commit to.

What?	When?	With Whom?

5. What support will you need to apply your learnings?

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